

Odisha reopens, and Gulf freight stays dear

● NETWORK: AMBER

Big Billion Days opens to everyone today¹, and most of the network goes into it in the season's usual shape. The East doesn't: Yesterday's bandh blocked highways across Odisha², and Kolkata bans goods vehicles tomorrow for Mahalaya. The other story is the Gulf, where shipping lines are adding ships to a route they still can't fully reach.

HOW'S EACH REGION HOLDING UP?



DATES TO WATCH

● Fri 9 Oct	Big Billion Days opens to everyone ¹
● 9–15 Oct	NH-10 night closures
● Sat 10 Oct	Kolkata Mahalaya truck ban
● 13–27 Oct	Kolkata Puja curbs and immersions ³
● Thu 15 Oct	Navi Mumbai demurrage waiver ends ⁴
● 26 Oct–5 Nov	NH-10 night closures, again
● Sat 31 Oct	Delhi's BS-IV exemption ends

● GREEN

the sale season as usual, which can still be busy

● AMBER

something beyond the season is slowing freight

● RED

something is stopping freight across a state or a route

North ● GREEN	Delhi's roads ran 11 points above usual on Wednesday and again on Thursday ⁵ , so the busy streak looks like the usual sale strain, so it's Green.
West ● GREEN	JNPA's pile of boxes waiting for trains inland fell for the third day running, to 1,782 on Thursday from 2,526 the day before ^{6,7} , with trucks turned round in about an hour and a half ⁶ . Kandla's queue grew to 64 ships waiting ⁸ , against a median of 51 since July. The ports are busy but not stuck, and the West's real headache is the air cargo at Navi Mumbai.
South ● GREEN	Chennai's roads ran 9 points above usual on Wednesday and Thursday, the most in the South, and Bengaluru's 5 and 6 ⁵ . That's the sale, as expected.
East ● AMBER	Yesterday's bandh blocked roads and national highways in ten districts and stopped buses and trucks ² . Paradip actually went into it strong, handling 451 thousand tonnes on Wednesday against 279 a year earlier ⁹ . Trucks held on NH-16 take a day or two to clear, and tomorrow Kolkata bans goods vehicles from 3 am to 10 pm for Mahalaya ³ .
Northeast ● AMBER	NH-10 into Sikkim stays shut at night till Thursday. The worry is tomorrow's Kolkata ban: by my estimate, the Northeast is the zone most exposed when Kolkata's hubs slow down, because so many of its parcels have no other road ¹⁰ .
Central ● GREEN	I found nothing beyond the usual seasonal strain in Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh or Vidarbha over the last two days.

1 The Gulf, and the price of a detour

● AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

So there's more space to the Gulf's edge, and less certainty past it. The exposure sits with exporters selling into Iraq, Kuwait and eastern Saudi Arabia, who are paying the highest rates for bookings that can still be pulled.

2 The best September trucks ever had

Will the extra trucks take the edge off spot rates on the parcel lanes before Diwali? I don't know, but I do know the exposure sits with shippers buying road space by the load rather than on contract.

3 Navi Mumbai, and the free week

● AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Navi Mumbai's airport has waived extra demurrage until 15th October, and promised more experienced staff, live flight-clearance updates and a 24/7 helpdesk for brokers⁴. It needed to: about 1,000 tonnes of imports were sitting on dollies, flight checks were running past 72 hours, and Challenge Group said freighters were leaving with little cargo or none¹⁵. Why are the freighters there at all? The main airport stopped taking them in

The exposure sits with pharma and electronics shippers whose Mumbai imports land in the busiest weeks of the year.

NH-16 through Odisha

Blocked at Bhubaneswar, Cuttack, Balasore, Bhadrak and Berhampur during Thursday's bandh, all of them on this road. Amber today and tomorrow while held trucks clear, then Green if nothing new comes.

NH-10 Siliguri–Gangtok

Shut to all vehicles 9 pm to 6 am on the Sevoke–Rangpo stretch till 15th October, and again 26th October–5th November¹⁷.

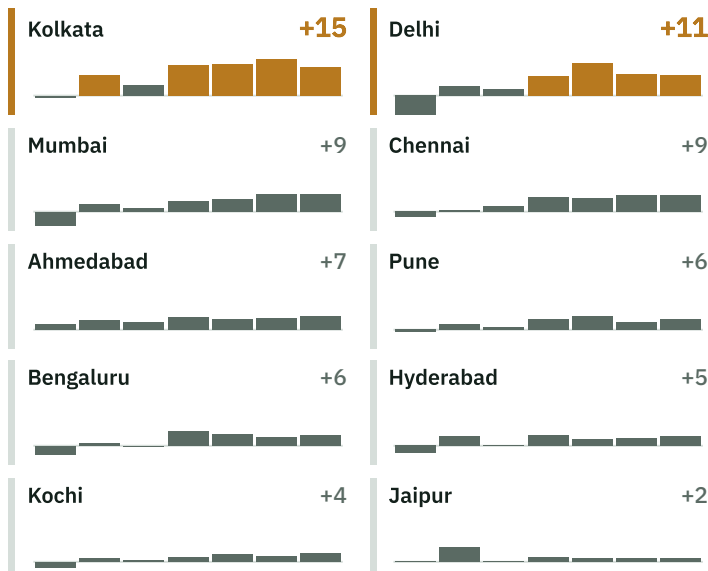
NH-44 Jammu-Srinagar

Very slow on Wednesday and Thursday with single-lane stretches, breakdowns and herds near Banihal–Nachlana; Kashmir-bound oil and gas tankers held 7 am to 7 pm¹⁸.

NH-154 Pathankot-Mandi

Dug up for repairs at Thakurdwara near Palampur, with long queues at peak hours; the work is stuck until water pipes and phone cables under the road are moved, and no end date is given¹⁹.

Kolkata is the one that stands out: 15 to 20 points over usual every weekday this week, before the Puja curbs even begin on the 13th. Delhi has held at 11 since the march, and every other city stayed under 10.



Built from public sources only. I rate against the season, because a sale week is never going to look like a quiet week in April, right? A Red road drags down the hubs at both ends, and a hub stays Amber about two days after its cause clears, longer after a Red. Air shows up only with measured numbers (AAI, WorldACD). Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. If I am wrong, we'll find out in the subsequent weeks. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Map boundaries:

[DataMeet](#), CC BY 4.0.

SOURCES

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